major civil rights protests—Freed captured and attempted to encroach on America's racial buffers, all the while mapping the color line and documenting other boundaries from his mobile perspective.

As a white Jewish photographer in the United States, he could not claim status or embody the role as a detached observer, so instead he considered how he might engage these scenes through close observation. Freed stated later, "[At] the time [white] Americans didn't really look at Black people. What I was trying to do was to show the faces and see the differences between them—look at what the Blacks really *look* like."[36] Freed tried to avoid visually overpowering his subjects, that is to say, to simply look over their shoulders and deny their perspective. He did feel the need to approach people, to document moments of mutual encounter. He did so not always simply to show what his subjects looked like but also to offer an affirmation or acknowledgment of their vision. No matter if they, or he, were in the way of a clear shot. Following his germinal opening image, he aimed to capture moments that lay bare the visible traces of legacies of division while approaching relational proximity.

The question of distancing, essential to Freed's work in photographing the foreign and familiar of Germany and as a white Jewish photographer in the United States, is also important to his subsequent American project on segregation. Freed's individual sense of perspective in many of these images allowed him to approach the fields of vision and the immediate physical space of his subjects (regardless of their perceived race) and around cultural landmarks, as he measured the buffers of a divided-color-line society. In the American images, he was more apt to mark his outsider status than to feign immersion. He achieved middle distance, for example, by facing his subjects while also mitigating access through indirect eye contact, locating objects or other figures between them, or including blurred figures on the periphery of his frame. The interplay between acknowledgment and dissociation underscores the racial divides in Freed's work during the years he produced images of segregation.

The photographs that would culminate in *Black in White America* locate and then invert the terms of a segregated society by shifting the focus of each image between the subject and the encroaching photographer. America is mapped here as a divided nation, not merely by North and South, but along many axes on both sides of the Mason-Dixon Line. Freed enters spaces that are rife with hostility (prisons, gatherings of unemployed men at